

HOUSE No. 3961**The Commonwealth of Massachusetts**

PRESENTED BY:

Joan Meschino

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to education and prevention of sudden unexpected death in epilepsy and other related epilepsy mortalities.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Joan Meschino</i>	<i>3rd Plymouth</i>	<i>1/16/2025</i>
<i>John Barrett, III</i>	<i>1st Berkshire</i>	<i>6/16/2025</i>
<i>Jennifer Balinsky Armini</i>	<i>8th Essex</i>	<i>6/16/2025</i>
<i>Sean Garballey</i>	<i>23rd Middlesex</i>	<i>6/16/2025</i>
<i>Patricia D. Jehlen</i>	<i>Second Middlesex</i>	<i>6/16/2025</i>
<i>Steven Ultrino</i>	<i>33rd Middlesex</i>	<i>6/16/2025</i>
<i>Ryan C. Fattman</i>	<i>Worcester and Hampden</i>	<i>6/24/2025</i>
<i>Rodney M. Elliott</i>	<i>16th Middlesex</i>	<i>7/2/2025</i>
<i>Michelle L. Badger</i>	<i>1st Plymouth</i>	<i>7/15/2025</i>
<i>Adrian C. Madaro</i>	<i>1st Suffolk</i>	<i>7/15/2025</i>
<i>Meghan K. Kilcoyne</i>	<i>12th Worcester</i>	<i>7/22/2025</i>
<i>Natalie M. Higgins</i>	<i>4th Worcester</i>	<i>8/5/2025</i>
<i>Adrienne Pusateri Ramos</i>	<i>14th Essex</i>	<i>9/23/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 3961

By Representative Meschino of Hull, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 3961) of Joan Meschino relative to education and prevention of sudden unexpected death in epilepsy and other related epilepsy mortalities. Public Health.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to education and prevention of sudden unexpected death in epilepsy and other related epilepsy mortalities.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Section 4G of chapter 111 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022
2 Official Edition, is hereby amended by adding the following paragraph:-

3 The department shall develop informational resources on sudden unexpected death in
4 epilepsy or “SUDEP” and other epilepsy-related mortalities to provide to epilepsy patients, their
5 families and health care providers. The information shall include, but not be limited to: (i)
6 current and evidence-based information about SUDEP and other epilepsy-related mortality risk
7 factors; (ii) contact information for non-profit organizations that provide support services for
8 patients with epilepsy conditions; and (iii) information on mitigating the risks of SUDEP and
9 other epilepsy-related mortalities. The department shall make the informational resources
10 available on its website in a manner that is easily accessible to patients, families and health care
11 providers.

SECTION 2. Not later than 1 year following the passage of this act, the department of public health shall submit to the clerks of the house of representatives and the senate and the joint committee on public health a report including a summary of relevant metrics, which shall include, but not be limited to: (i) the information gathered for the informational resources; (ii) its efforts to provide this information to patients, families and health care providers; (iii) the effects of the informational resources on patient outcomes; and (iv) obstacles encountered in disseminating informational resources. The department shall incorporate public input in the development of the report.

SECTION 3. The department of public health shall conduct a statewide campaign to raise public awareness about SUDEP and other epilepsy-related mortalities.